NEWSBEATS

Your daily news, in a hit song.

Pre-Seed Round · Raising £1M–£1.5M

newsbeats.vercel.app

April 2026

THE PROBLEM

Gen Z stopped reading the news.

But they never stopped wanting to know what's happening.

67%

decline in newspaper circulation since 1990

39%

of people actively avoid the news (Reuters 2025)

54%

of under-35s get news from social/audio first

The problem isn't apathy. It's format.

Gen Z spends 4+ hours daily inside audio and social apps. They don't have time to read articles — they need information delivered in the formats they already live in: audio, rhythm, and music.

THE SOLUTION

We don't read you the news. We play it.

STEP 01

You pick your topics

Choose World, Business, Sports, Tech and more. Select your genre: Hip-Hop, Pop, Jazz, EDM, Reggaeton, R&B.

STEP 02

AI does everything

We fetch today's real headlines, write lyrics packed with facts, and generate a full song via AI — all in under 60 seconds.

STEP 03

You listen and share

A fresh 2–6 min song every day. Today's news, sung. No reading. No scrolling. No skipping.

"It's Friday the 4th of April — let me break down the world..." — AI-generated Hip-Hop beat based on today's real headlines

THE PRODUCT

NewsBeats — Live at newsbeats.vercel.app

6 languages

EN, FR, ES, DE, PT, IT — lyrics generated and sung in your language

Flash & Deep Dive

2-min Flash (5 stories) or 6-min Deep Dive (15 stories)

6 music genres

Hip-Hop, Pop, Reggaeton, R&B, Afrobeat, EDM

Real AI pipeline

Claude AI writes lyrics · ACE-Step sings them · Cloudflare stores them

8 news topics

World, Business, Tech, Politics, Science, Sports, Entertainment, Health

Date-anchored

Every song opens: "It's Friday the 4th of April..." — grounded in today

Tech stack: Claude API · ACE-Step / Replicate · Cloudflare R2 · Upstash Redis · Next.js · Vercel · Guardian API

MARKET OPPORTUNITY

A $177B convergence.

TOTAL ADDRESSABLE MARKET	SERVICEABLE ADDRESSABLE MARKET	SERVICEABLE OBTAINABLE MARKET
$177B	**$11B**	**$30M**
Podcast + Music Streaming + AI Music by 2030	Audio news + AI-generated music English-speaking markets	350K–1M active users Year 3 target at $2.50 ARPU

- Podcast market: $131B by 2030 · 27% CAGR (Grand View Research)
- Music streaming: $108B by 2030 · 14.9% CAGR (Grand View Research)
- AI Music: $3B by 2030 · 30% CAGR (Spherical Insights)
- 547M global podcast listeners in 2024 → 619M by 2026

WHY NOW

Three forces converging in 2026.

01

Gen Z has gone audio-native

- 75% of Gen Z adults listen to podcasts (2025)
- 63% of Americans 13–24 are monthly podcast listeners
- 54% of under-35s: social/audio is their primary news source
- News avoidance hit a record 39% globally (Reuters DNR 2025)

02

AI music has reached commercial grade

- Suno: $2.45B valuation · 100M users · 7M tracks/day
- ElevenLabs: $11B valuation · $500M Series D · Feb 2026
- ACE-Step 1.5: generates full songs in under 2 seconds
- Apple acquired audio AI startup for $2B · Feb 2026

03

Native audio ads are exploding

- Audio gets 2.7 hrs/day of attention but only 4.5% of ad spend
- Podcast ad CPMs: $21–28 vs display $5–15
- Native ad market: $130B growing at 12% CAGR
- AI-personalized audio ads: +22pp brand favorability lift

BUSINESS MODEL

Built for scale. Multiple paths to revenue.

PRIMARY — Native Brand Beats (audio-in-flow advertising)

Brands are woven directly into the lyrics — contextually, humorously, and seamlessly. Not a pre-roll. Not a banner. The ad IS part of the song.

Zero skip rate · £30–50 CPM · 3–5x standard audio · Patentable format

PRIMARY STRATEGY

No banners.
No pre-rolls.
Just great music.

Freemium Subscription

Free tier supported by native ads. Premium tier (ad-free, offline, personalisation) for power users who prefer a clean experience. Pricing TBD based on user research.

Optional — pursued if user demand signals it

B2B Licensing

White-label the AI news-to-music engine to radio groups, publishers and media companies. They launch their own branded product. We provide the pipeline.

iHeart · BBC · Spotify · publishers

Chrome Extension

Turn any article you're reading into a 60-second beat — instantly. Different from the daily digest; a per-article audio companion. New monetisation surface.

Post-raise product expansion

MONETISATION INNOVATION

The ad IS the beat.

A patentable, first-of-its-kind advertising format.

How it works

1. Advertiser provides: brand name, message, sonic identity, target topics
2. AI matches news context to brand brief (e.g. Trump exits war → Guide du Routard)
3. Claude writes a lyric line that references the brand naturally and humorously
4. The beat is generated with the brand reference woven into the song itself
5. User hears a great song — brand gets context-perfect, frictionless placement
6. A small ✦ icon marks the sponsored line — legally compliant, visually minimal

Example lyric placement

"Trump's looking for the exit ramp, maybe check the Routard map..." ✦

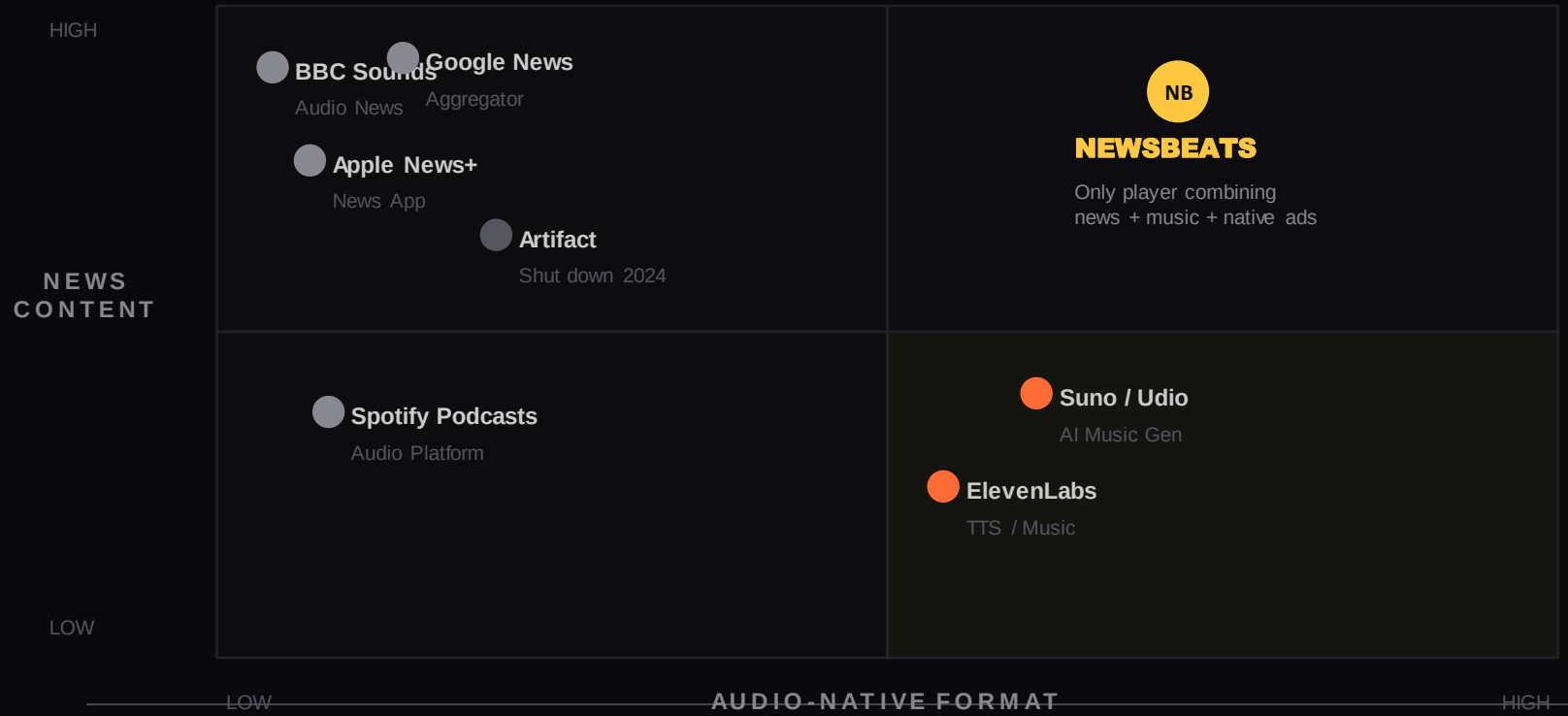
Why it wins vs. standard audio ads

✓ Zero skip rate — user hears it as content
✓ +22pp brand favorability (AI-personalised audio)
✓ Context-matched placement: 75% higher recall
✓ £30–50 CPM vs £5–15 standard display

Audio captures only 4.5% of ad spend despite 2h42m of daily listening · Native ad market: $130B growing 12% annually (Grand View Research, 2024)

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Nobody does what we do.



KEY INSIGHT

No competitor combines:

- Real-time news
- AI-generated music
- Lyrics users can hear sung
- Native brand integration

TRACTION & VALIDATION

Built and live. Fast.

Feb 2026

Concept validated

Identified white space at intersection of AI music + news consumption

Mar 2026

MVP built

Full pipeline: real news → AI lyrics → AI-generated sung song. App live.

Apr 2026

Public beta

newsbeats.vercel.app — 6 languages, 6 genres, 8 topics, Flash + Deep Dive modes

Now

Raising pre-seed

Seeking £1–1.5M to scale product, acquire users, launch native ad pilots

Key proof points

✓ Full AI pipeline operational — real news to sung song in <90 seconds

✓ Smart caching: same combo served to unlimited users at ~zero marginal cost

✓ 6 languages + 6 genres validated with test users

✓ ACE-Step API: $0.015/song — unit economics proven at scale

UNIT ECONOMICS

Designed to scale near zero marginal cost.

Cost per song generated

ACE-Step via Replicate	$0.015
Claude API (lyrics)	$0.003
Guardian API (news)	$0.000
Cloudflare R2 (storage)	$0.001
Other infra (Redis, Vercel)	$0.001
TOTAL COST PER SONG	**~$0.020**

The cache multiplier

Same combo (e.g. EN+HipHop+Flash+World/Business) generated ONCE — served to unlimited users at zero extra cost. 1,000 users requesting the same beat = 1 API call, not 1,000.

Real cost at 100K users: ~$200/month in API costs

Revenue vs. cost at scale

100K users, 3% premium	£15K/mo	99%
5 brand partners @ £5K/mo	£25K/mo	>95%
2 B2B licences @ £10K/mo	£20K/mo	>95%

GO-TO-MARKET

Launch fast. Own the format.

PHASE 1 · Months 1–6	PHASE 2 · Months 6–12	PHASE 3 · Months 12–18
Beachhead: English-speaking Gen	**Expand + Monetise**	**B2B + Seed raise**
Target: 18–28 year olds, UK + US	Launch in FR, ES, DE — same product, localised content	Pitch first B2B licence to radio group or publisher
Channel: TikTok + Instagram Reels — post daily news beats, let virality do the work	First 3–5 brand beat pilot campaigns	Scale native ad programme to 10+ brands
Creator partnerships: pay 10 news creators to share their daily beat	Premium subscription launch	Raise £3–5M seed at £20–30M valuation
Product hunt + app store launch	Campus ambassador programme (UK universities)	Target: 100K–200K MAUs
Target: 10,000 MAUs	Target: 50,000 MAUs · First revenue	ARR target: £1–2M

STRATEGIC UPSIDE

Built to grow. Positioned to exit.

Apple acquired Q.ai (audio AI startup) for $2 billion — Feb 2026. Its biggest deal since Beats.

This signals that major tech and media companies view audio AI as core strategic infrastructure worth paying for.

Tech Giants

Spotify · Apple · Google

Gen Z audio attention + native AI music format = core platform play. Spotify has 751M MAUs and is racing to differentiate from Apple Music.

Radio & Broadcast Groups

iHeart · Global · Bauer

iHeart generated $1.1B in podcast revenue in 2024 but faces digital migration. NewsBeats is the AI-native format they can't build internally fast enough.

News & Media Publishers

Guardian · BBC · Axel Springer

Publishers are desperate to reach Gen Z. A music-native news format paired with licensed content solves their biggest distribution problem.

Adtech & Social Platforms

Meta · ByteDance · Snap

The native brand beat format is a genuinely new ad product with measurable performance. An acquisition gives them defensible audio-native advertising IP.

Suno: $2.45B valuation · ElevenLabs: $11B valuation · Comparable AI/audio transactions signal strong appetite for category consolidation

THE TEAM

Built by someone who lives the problem.

Founder

London, UK · Available on request

- Senior finance professional — advisory background across corporate transactions and strategic finance
- Top European business school graduate
- Multilingual (EN, FR, ES) — built for multi-market from day one
- Product builder — multiple self-published projects live on Amazon. Built this MVP solo using AI tools.

Why this founder owns this category

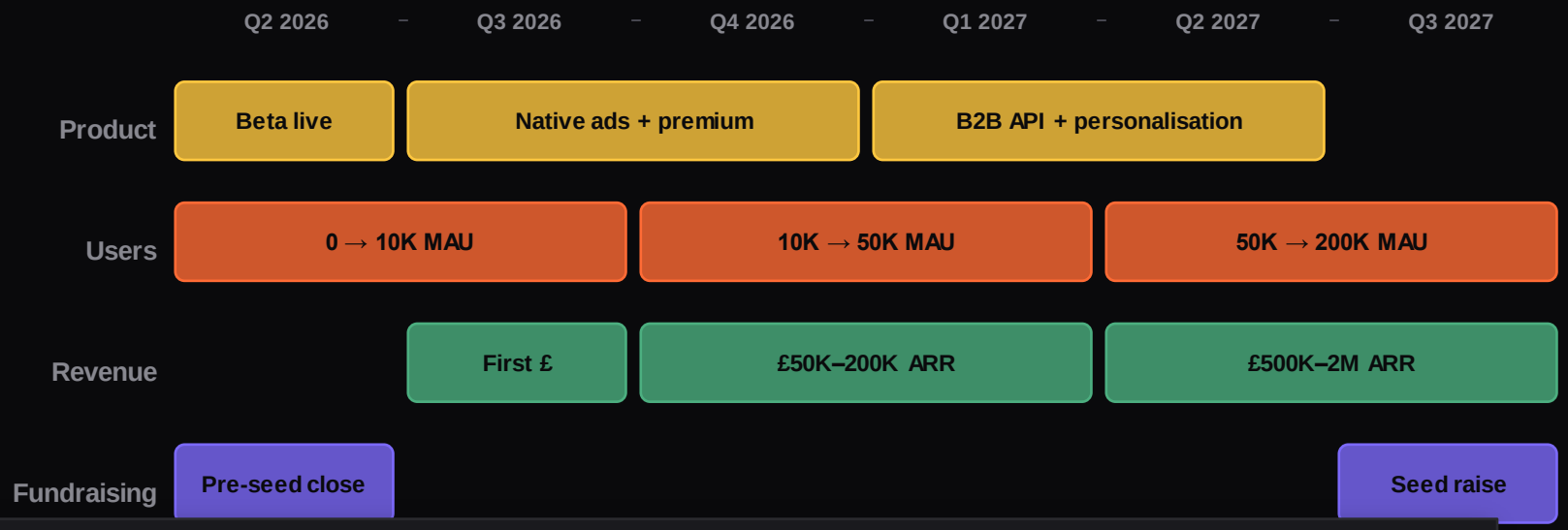
A finance professional who is time-poor, news-hungry, and multilingual by default. Understands monetisation and institutional pitching. Built a working AI product solo — no team, no budget, in weeks. That's the founder-market fit.

First hires (post-raise)

→ CTO / Full-stack AI engineer
→ Growth lead (social/audio native)
→ Brand partnerships lead

ROADMAP & FINANCIALS

18 months to seed-ready.



Use of funds — £1.25M raise

Product & Engineering (45%) — £560K
CTO hire, AI pipeline improvements, iOS/Android apps

Growth & Marketing (35%) — £440K
Creator partnerships, paid social, brand deal team

Operations & Legal (20%) — £250K
Team, admin, IP protection, compliance

BETA vs. FINAL PRODUCT

Where we are. Where we're going.

BETA — Live now

- ✓ Web app live — newsbeats.vercel.app
- ✓ 6 languages · 6 genres · 8 topics
- ✓ Flash (2 min) + Deep Dive (6 min)
- ✓ Real Guardian API news headlines
- ✓ Claude AI lyrics — fact-dense, date-anchored
- ✓ ACE-Step AI sings the lyrics (not TTS)
- ✓ Cloudflare R2 + Redis smart caching
- ✓ Daily combo cache — scales to 1M users free
- ○ No daily cap — unlimited generation

FINAL PRODUCT — Post-raise

- iOS + Android native apps — daily beat as morning habit
- Chrome Extension — sing any article you're reading (see slide 17)
- Suno API: production-grade vocals, industry-leading song quality
- Personalised recommendations (genre, topic, language history)
- Daily push notification — "Your beat is ready"
- Social sharing — branded waveform card, shareable on Reels
- Native brand beat ad system (live pilots with 3–5 brands)
- Themes: Chill, Hype, Lo-Fi, Acoustic, Classical versions
- Extended topics: Climate, Finance, Crypto, Football

On Suno: Beta uses ACE-Step ($0.015/song, good quality). Final product targets Suno API ($0.03/song) — significantly higher vocal realism, more natural singing, broader genre range. Suno = $2.45B valuation, 100M users, industry standard for AI-sung lyrics.

ITERATIONS & EXPANSION

Every axis is an expansion lever.

Chrome Extension

→ Read any article → click → AI turns it into a 60-sec beat
→ Not the daily digest — a per-article, on-demand format
→ Works on Guardian, NYT, BBC, Le Monde, any news site
→ Brand placement contextualised to that specific article
→ New monetisation surface: per-article sponsor slots

Music Themes & Quality

→ ACE-Step (beta) → Suno API (final) for pro-grade vocals
→ Chill / Lo-Fi — relaxed tempo, study-friendly
→ Hype / Club — 140 BPM, festival energy
→ Acoustic — guitar, stripped back, intimate
→ K-Pop, Bossa Nova, Country — genre expansion roadmap

Topic & Format Expansion

→ Climate, Crypto, Finance, Football editions
→ City-level local news (London, Paris, NYC...)
→ Weekly Recap — Sunday best-of (10 min)
→ Breaking News — instant alert song (<5 min)
→ Remixes — same news, 3 different genres

Platform & Social

→ iOS + Android native apps with daily notification
→ Branded waveform card — shareable on Reels/TikTok
→ Lyric sync display — scrolling like Spotify
→ Duet mode — two AI voices debate a topic
→ Voice selection — male/female/accent/language

The Chrome Extension alone is a separate product category — on-demand, per-article audio — with its own monetisation surface and distribution channel (Chrome Web Store + publisher partnerships).

THE ASK

Raising £1M–£1.5M

Pre-Seed SAFE · £8–12M post-money valuation cap

01 10,000 → 50,000 MAUs in 12 months via creator + social strategy

02 First 5 brand beat pilots generating native ad revenue

03 iOS/Android apps + B2B licensing conversations — seed-ready at 12 months

"Your daily news, in a hit song."

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